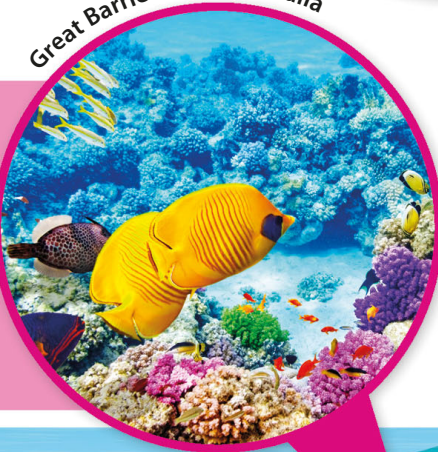




Mupe Bay, Jurassic Coast, Dorset, UK

Great Barrier Reef, Australia



Coral reefs

These are made from the skeletons left by tiny sea animals, called coral polyps, when they die. The skeletons build up into huge reefs, where plants and other sea creatures live.

Rock pools

When the tide goes out on a rocky seashore, pools of water are left behind in holes in the rocks. These then become home to a huge range of plants and animals, such as shellfish and sea anemones.

Oceanic ridge

Moving tectonic plates can also create underwater mountains. The Mid-Atlantic Ridge, under the Atlantic Ocean, is more than 64,000 km (40,000 miles) long.

Hydrothermal vents

When sea water filters down cracks in the Earth's crust, it is heated by volcanic activity. Hot water then spurts out through the cracks or vents.

! WOW!

Nearly **95%** of the world's oceans remain **unexplored!**